

Scammed!

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Characters:

Anirudh: Indian male about 26 year old

Entities: Unknown Humanoids

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - EVENING

Scene is dark and we hear phone conversation between two people.

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Sahaj Patel se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji mera hi naam hai.

ANIRUDH

Patelji, aap meri baat dhyaan se sunein aur call disconnect na karein. Aapke khilaaf serious charges hain aur filhaal aap under investigation hain.

CALLEE

Kya baat kar rhe hain?

ANIRUDH

Ji, ek overseas bank account mila hai jisse aapka phone number aur PAN linked hai. Us account se pandrah crore se zyada ke fraudulent transactions hue hain. Aur—

CALLEE

Bhai sahab kya bole ja rhe hain? Mera koi overseas account hai hi nhi.

ANIRUDH

Aapka address Anand Vihaar, Noida ka hai, aur aapka PAN number bhi usi account se linked hai.

CALLEE

Lekin sir itna bada allegation aise hi laga rhe hain aap.

ANIRUDH

Filhaal aap investigation me cooperate kijiye. Kyonki aapke naam pe arrest warrant hai.

CALLEE

Arre nhi sir, mujhe fasaya ja rha hai. Mere naam pe aaj tak chaalaan tak nhi kata, aap arrest warrant ki baat kar rhe hain.

ANIRUDH

Dekhiye isi liye keh rha hu, aap cooperate kijiye. Mai secondary verification ka process start kar rha hu. Mai aapse kuch details poochunga records se match karane ke liye, theek hai?

CALLEE

Theek hai sir.

ANIRUDH

Aapka poora naam Sahaj Kumar Patel hai, right?

CALLEE

Ji.

ANIRUDH

Apna Date of Birth bataiye.

CALLEE

22nd March, 1965.

ANIRUDH

Theek hai. Ab aapke mobile pe ek verification code aayega. Woh mujhe bata dijiye.

Anirudh initiates Marauder Script.

ANIRUDH

Check kijiye.

CALLEE

Ji... 5182...(Inaudible)

ANIRUDH

Theek hai Patelji. Aapne investigation me poora cooperate kiya. Mai aapka arrest warrant hold pe daal rha hu. Ab aap nischint rahiye.

CALLEE

Theek hai sir, dhanyawaad.

ANIRUDH

Chaliye. Shubh ratri.

Satisfied. Anirudh hangs up. Marks lead as "Harvest Complete". He leans back on his chair and checks time. Suddenly his phone rings. Caller ID says Supervisor sir.

ANIRUDH

Hello?

SUPERVISOR

Updated list mila ki nahi tumko,
Anirudh?

ANIRUDH

Um- check kar rha hu sir.

SUPERVISOR

Check karke batao kitne leads hain
total?

ANIRUDH

30 hain sir.

SUPERVISOR

20 Harvest chahiye. Ho jaayega?

ANIRUDH

20 Harvest?

SUPERVISOR

Minimum 20.

ANIRUDH

Hmm...

SUPERVISOR

Ek high value target hai. Uska
Document alag se hai. Call karne
se pehle dekh lena jaroor.

ANIRUDH

Hanji bilkul.

SUPERVISOR

Chalo shuru kar do.

Anirudh he cracks his fingers. Pick the first target in the list. Dials the number using the CRM tool. The call connects after a few seconds.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol
rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division
se. Kya meri baat Mr. Gopiraj se
ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji nhi, mai unka beta bol rha hu.
Kya chahiye aapko?

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj ji ko phone dijiyega.
Mujhe unse hi baat karni hai.

CALLEE

Pitaji busy hain. Aap mujhse hi baat kijiye.

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj ji busy hain? Aur jinse baat ho rhi hai unka naam?

CALLEE

Aapki baat desh ke Pradhaan Mantri se ho rhi hai.

ANIRUDH

Ye kaun sa tareeka hai baat karne ka, han? Tumhaare pitaji jail jaane waale hain aur tumko mazak soojh rha hai?

CALLEE

Accha? Kis khushi mein jail jayenge woh?

ANIRUDH

CBI ki investigation hai. Case details tumhaare saath share nahi kar sakta. Gopiraj ji ko phone dijiye, please.

CALLEE

Dekho phone toh nhi de rha mai.

ANIRUDH

Theek hai. Investigation mein interference karne ke jurm me tumhaare against bhi warrant issue karwa deta hu.

CALLEE

(Laughs)

Itna aukaat hai kya tumhara?

ANIRUDH

Abhi toh aur hasi aayegi. Tere naam pe itne cases khlunga na, gin nhi paayega.

CALLEE

Aur tere naam pe OnlyFans kholunga. Bees rupaye mein mujra karwaunga tujhse saale.

ANIRUDH

Tu government officer se battameezi kar raha hai. Samajh nahi aa raha tujhe kya hoga.

CALLEE

Arre ja jo ukhaarna hai ukhaar le. Bohot dekhe hain tere jaise.

ANIRUDH

Ruk. Batata hu tujhe—

Call disconnects abruptly cutting Anirudh off. He mutters something to himself angrily while shaking his fist. Silence for few seconds.

Suddenly there is a loud thud outside his room. He is startled. He grabs a stick and his mobile. Turns on flashlight and goes outside his room. There is a wooden chair outside which has toppled. He goes outside and sits it up again. The chair now casts a shadow into the room through the door.

He relaxes and then returns to his workstation to mark the lead as failed. Checks another lead and hesitates for some time. Then he takes a deep breath and starts calling the numbers. CALL MONTAGE BEGINS.

ANIRUDH

(Montage repeat)

Hello, Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu
CBI, Cybercrime division se

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Kya meri baat Mr. Piyush se ho rhi
hai?
Kya meri baat Mrs. Payal se ho rhi
hai?
Kya meri baat Mohd. Sarfaraaz se
ho rhi hai?

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Aapke against serious charges
hain.
Aapke naam pe illegal transfers
hue hain.

ANIRUDH

(Montage Cuts)

Verification code share kijiye.
Verification code aaya hoga aapko.
Verification code ko padhiye.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE EVENING

Anirudh looks at the Sheet and the next person is named as Mahutla Surashendu, note beside his name says: Ex-Diplomat, High Value Target, Refer Doc-13 for more intel. Anirudh opens Doc-13 and it has some information like: Possible off-shore accounts. Previously booked for unverified money transfers, released due to lack of evidence. Associated with with Sleeper blocks and was investigated under UAPA, results inconclusive. Mention of term Outpost-225 in several old intelligence reports. No information regarding what that is.

After reading the doc he checks the number. His number is 112005116.

ANIRUDH

Ab ye kaisa number hai?

He asks himself as he dials it. Call connects after few seconds.

CALLEE

Hello

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. uh-Mahutla se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

Ji bol rha hu.

ANIRUDH

Mahutilaji aapke naam ka ek previous case reopen hua hai. Toh usi ke baare me mujhe aapse kuch sawaal poochne hain.

CALLEE

Mr. Jo bhi naam hai aapka. I used to be a Diplomat, okay? Aise call pe kaun si government agency threaten karti hai? You think I am an idiot?

ANIRUDH

Careful Mr. Mahutla, humein underestimate karne ki galti mat kijiyege. We know everything about your past.

CALLEE

Nonsense! You know absolutely nothing.

ANIRUDH

We know about your offshore accounts and your association with Sleeper cells. We can do more damage to your reputation than you think.

CALLEE

You are just wasting my time. Kisi aur ke saath jaake time pass kijiye.

ANIRUDH

What if I tell you that I know everything about Outpost Two Twenty Five.

CALLEE

(Few seconds silence)

Sorry, come again?

ANIRUDH

I said mujhe Outpost Two Two Five ke baare me sab kuch pata hai.

CALLEE

(Again few seconds silence)

Hmm... Call me on my secure line. Note kijiye number-005172007.

Call disconnects. Anirudh is shaking a bit. He dials the number that callee gave him. Call connects.

ANIRUDH

Hello?

CALLEE

Hanji, iss line se connect karwane ka ek hi purpose hai, aapko batana ki there is a certain line you should not cross.

ANIRUDH

Aye! Dhamkane ki koshish kar rha hai tu mujhe?

CALLEE

Oh no not at all. Please enjoy the music I will be right back.

ANIRUDH

What?

Strange high pitched mechanical noise blurts from the speaker. Anirudh move the phone away from himself. Slowly brings it closer. The noise continues for sometime. Then stops.

ANIRUDH

Hello?

CALLEE

I hope you enjoyed the music.

ANIRUDH

Kya tha woh?

CALLEE

Oh nothing to worry about. Have a nice day.

Before Anirudh can say something call disconnects. He sinks his face into his hands and stays like that for a while.

Camera slowly pans and we can see that there is a shadow of a person sitting on the chair. Then, there is a single knock/tap on a nearby door. Anirudh raises his head up and looks to his side. Notices the shadow. The shadow gets up and leaves to the right.

Anirudh is alarmed. He grabs his flashlight and checks outside through the door. A shawl of some sort is suspended from the wire on the right side of the roof. At a distance feet of a person is barely visible emerging near a wall turn at the end of the roof. It slowly pulls backwards.

Anirudh sees absolutely nothing. Scratches his head and returns back to his workstation and this time he rotates his chair slightly to keep an eye on the door.

Then starts calling people again. Next person is Shubhankar from Kolkata. He dials the number and call connects.

CALLEE

Hello, ke?

ANIRUDH

Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division se. Kya meri baat Mr. Shubhankar se ho rhi hai?

CALLEE

(Speaks to someone else nearby)

Arre jaani na, bolche CBI theke, 1 min.

ANIRUDH

Hello Shubhankar ji?

CALLEE

Ji ji bataiye.

ANIRUDH

Shubhankar ji mujhe ek case file pa assign kiya gaya hai jisme ki aapka naam saamne aaya hai. Hello?

Some commotion is audible on the other side.

CALLEE

(Speaks to someone else nearby)

Arre darao na, kotha bolchi toh.

ANIRUDH

Shubhankarji! Kya aap meri baat pe thoda focus karenge please?

CALLEE

(Speaks sternly)

Arre kaun Shubhankar? Mai Gopiraj bol rha hu. Aapko baat karni tha na mujhse?

ANIRUDH

Gopiraj? Meri Shubhankarji se baat ho rhi thi na? Ye kisko call lag gaya? Hello Shubhankarji?

CALLEE

(Voice slightly garbled)

Arre bhai sahab mai Gopiraj baat kar rha hu. Aapki baat hui thi mere bete se.

Confused Anirudh checks the number again. The call log shows Shubhankar.

ANIRUDH

Ye log toh Shubhankar hi dikha rha hai. Kisko call lag gaya?

He checks the number and speaks again.

CALLEE

Hello?

ANIRUDH

Hello? Shubhankarji?

CALLEE

Arre dada aapko mujhse baat karna hai ya Gopiraj ji se aap ye clear kijiiye na?

ANIRUDH

Kya? Gopiraj ji hain kya aapke saath wahan?

CALLEE

Nhi nhi Gopiraj ji toh aapke udhar hain.

ANIRUDH

(Extremely confused)

Kyyaa?

CALLEE

(Speaking slowly)

Ji, aapke room ke bahar... wait kar rhe hain woh aapka.

At the corner of his eye just outside his door/window he notices a hand holding the metal grill, standing just outside his door/window. But the moment he looks at the hand it pulls backward.

Alarmed Anirudh drops his headphone, grabs his stick and turns on flashlight.

ANIRUDH
(Exclaims)
Kaun hai!

Opens his door and barges outside. Looks to the left, nothing. Looks to the right, the shawl hanging from the wire now seems like a person. Anirudh carefully approaches the formation. As he comes close enough he swings his stick hard and fast and the shawl comes off and falls to the ground. There is no human. He then lifts it up and hangs it back on the wire.

ANIRUDH
Saala, kya ho rha hai ye mere
saath?

Anirudh stands scratching his head for a second and then slowly returns to his room.

He steps inside with the flashlight off. The moment he looks inside he sees a human figure just next to his PC. Scared he quickly turns on his flashlight and sees that its just a shirt suspended on his pedestal fan.

He then pulls out a padlock from his drawer. Walks up to the door and proceeds to secure it with the padlock. He then checks the next target on the list.

As he checks he notices several names on the top of the list now have "DECEASED" in the Notes section of the list.

ANIRUDH
Ye maine kab likha?

As he clicks on them they disappear. He then dials the next number. Call connects.

CALLEE
Hello kaun?

ANIRUDH
Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol
rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division
se. Kya meri baat Usman ji se ho
rhi hai?

CALLEE
Ji bol rha hu?

ANIRUDH

Usman ji mujhe ek case file pa
assign kiya gaya hai jisme ki
aapka naam saamne aaya hai.

CALLEE

(Static and Garbled
voice)

Yahi kahan tha na tune Patelji se
bhi?

ANIRUDH

(Flabbergasted)

Kya? Ye kya bol rhe hain?

CALLEE

(Distressed)

Sab yaad hai mujhe.

Anirudh is speechless. Then blinks and suddenly his laptop is not there in front of him anymore. But he is wearing his headphone with its cord disconnected.

Voices comes from the headphones.

VOICES

Inspector sahab, sab yaad hai
mujhe.

Aap ko toh OTP chahiye bus.
Please humein arrest mat kijiyeega.

He checks the headphone cord that is now disconnected from the laptop. He gets scared. He starts looking around. His laptop is not there in his room. He looks outside from his window. And the laptop is sitting on the broken chair outside his room. Anirudh is confused.

ANIRUDH

Saala kya ho rha hai mere saath
ye?

He grabs his key and unlocks the door. He goes and picks up the laptop. [The shawl should be missing from the wire this time around] While he is doing this, something behind him enters his room. Anirudh does not see this. he returns back and locks the room again from inside.

Before he sits he notices the shawl inside the room near the window.

ANIRUDH

Ab ye kaise andar aaya?

He uses the stick to lift the shawl and tosses it out of his window. He then returns to his laptop.

Anirudh then checks the final entry on the list, it says:
Anirudh G and shows his number.

INT. ROOFTOP ROOM - LATE NIGHT

Anirudh picks up his phone and calls his manager.

ANIRUDH

Hello sir.

SUPERVISOR

Hanji Anirudh bhai, kya hua?

ANIRUDH

Sir, ye mera naam list pe kyon hai?

SUPERVISOR

Han? Kya bol rhe ho? Tumhara naam kyon hoga list pe?

ANIRUDH

Sir, ispe Anirudh G likha hai and this looks like my number.

SUPERVISOR

Toh tum keh rhe ho poori duniya bus tum hi ek Anirudh G ho?

ANIRUDH

But sir, ye number...

SUPERVISOR

Bhai tumne Ganja phoonk liya hai kya? Kya ulta seedha bol rhe ho?

ANIRUDH

Nhi sir, pata nhi kya ho rha hai. But lag rha hai ye mera number.

SUPERVISOR

Abe phone kar aur dekh le na? Kya time kharab kar rha hai mera.

ANIRUDH

Sir kuch theek nhi lag rha mujhe. Ajeeb cheezein ho rhi hain mere saath.

SUPERVISOR

Sun mere bhai, ek ehsaan kar mere upar. List khatam kar, aur report submit karde. Please, raat ke 11 baj rhe hain mujhse aur nhi ho rha.

ANIRUDH

Suniye toh sir, Kuch toh bohot ajeeb sa hi ho rha hai yahan.

SUPERVISOR
 (Voice getting Garbled)
 Anirudh list khatam kar de... List
 khatam kar de Anirudh...

ANIRUDH
 Kya hua sir?

Call disconnects.

ANIRUDH
 Hello? Hello?

Anirudh puts the phone down.

PHONE
 (Garbled Voice)
 List khatam kar...

ANIRUDH
 What the fuck? Ye kya tha?

[Start hanging the entity down secretly from mid of the above dialogue sequence] At the corner of his eye he sees the shawl and a face slowly hanging down from the top of his door. Anirudh grabs his flashlight again and shines light on the door, it immediately makes a sudden movement and flies to the right side.

And from the right side of the window a shawl comes flying inside the room. Anirudh panics and dives to the left side of the room. His headphone cord rips from his laptop and his phone drops to the right side. As he goes to the corner of the door he sees some entities standing inside his room at the far end near the cooler.

Scared, he looks around the room and the door. He gets up, picks up the door key and goes near the door. He tries opening but sees that the lock is on the other side of the door. He realizes he is trapped in the room.

ANIRUDH
 Oh fuck. Kya karun, kya karun mai!
 Phone kahan gaya mera.

He looks for his phone but its not there with him.

VOICES
 Kaam poora kijiye Inspector sahab.
 Abhi duty baaki hai aapki.

Anirudh huddles at the corner of the room.

VOICES
 (Loudly)
 ANIRUDH!

Sudden voice from his left outside the door startles him.
[There is a face outside the door when this happens, it immediately disappears]

The laptop is just outside the door with the headphone and mouse connected to it. Anirudh looks at it for few seconds.

He then grabs the mouse and dials Emergency number on the dialer. Someone picks up on the other side.

SUPERVISOR

Hello, Anirudh? Fir se kyon call
kiya? Report daal di tune?

ANIRUDH

What? No sir! Maine aapko nhi call
kiya! Mai toh... Mai toh... ye
Emergency no pe call kiya.

SUPERVISOR

Are you out of your mind? Abe
dimaag sahi me kharab ho gaya hai
kya tumhara?

ANIRUDH

Nhi Sir! Baat samajhiye. Mai apne
hi room me lock ho gaya hu sir. I
need help, mujhe samajh me nhi aa
rha hai kya karun.

SUPERVISOR

(Voice getting Garbled)

Maine kaha na List khatam karne
ko... List khatam kar de
Anirudh...

Anirudh hangs up. He grabs his head in distress. He opens the dialer and slowly types in the number and hesitantly presses Dial.

Silence hangs for 15-20 seconds. Then his personal phone starts ringing. Anirudh leans to see. It's sitting midway between him and the entities standing at the corner of his room. He slowly removes the headphone from his head.

Anirudh slowly starts crawling towards the phone. The camera perspective shifts and now we see from the other end Anirudh crawling towards the camera. Something pushes the mobile towards Anirudh from behind the camera.

Anirudh looks at his phone. Caller ID says Unknown Number. Anirudh slowly picks up.

ANIRUDH

Hel...Hello?

VOICE

(Same sound as Anirudh)
Hello, main Inspector Vijaya bol
rha hu CBI ke Cybercrime Division
se. Kya meri baat Mr. Anirudh-ji
se ho rhi hai?

ANIRUDH

(Panicking)
Kya? Kaun bol rha hai?

VOICE

Main Inspector Vijaya bol rha hu,
mujhe assign kiya gaya hai ek case
file me, jispe ki aapka naam
saamne aaya hai...

ANIRUDH

Nhi nhi nhi. Ye nhi ho sakta.
Kaise? Ye nhi ho sakta.

Anirudh drops his phone. He backs up against his PC desk. A
hand from underneath it grabs and pulls him inside.

Camera focuses on the phone lying on the ground.

VOICE

Hello sir, meri awaaz aa rhi hai
aapko? Hello?

FADE OUT